



What we need

The opening pages of *Cruising the Canyon* briefly run through a method on installing Bryce 3D 3 on your system, specifically via a virtual machine, then mounted onto the main machine. It was glossed by in CTC so the finer details of that process might be a bit confusing. However, this guide hopefully will run through the process in an easy to follow way.

First things first, download Bryce 3 from the Internet Archive. This can be done using [this link](#). The page and comments left on the page include all of the details you'll need to successfully install Bryce on the virtual machine. Unfortunately, we're a bit away from that step.

Note: The original uploader included in the Bryce3DCD.iso a bunch of presets for Bryce. These are pretty nifty so hang on to the .iso file. Or if you would prefer, first mount the .iso, extract all of the preset folders out, then un-mount and continue with the virtual machine.

These presets also work with Bryce 7.

Next, we'll need a virtual machine to install Bryce 3 since newer operating systems do not support its installer. I personally use [VirtualBox](#) but I'm not too savvy with virtual machines. Just keep in mind that we won't be needing it to run Bryce 3 each time. We only need it once for the installer.

While you wait for the VirtualBox installer to download, you might as well **get the final file we'll need; a Windows XP .iso**. You can find images all over the Internet Archive, but I'm using [this one](#) for this tutorial. Again, the virtual machine is only a means to install Bryce, so don't stress over which version of XP to choose.

Make sure to download the image using the files listed on the right of the page. Don't go looking for the file installer in the reviews. I assure you they don't have it, and whatever they do have won't help you install Bryce 3 :)



While you wait for the Windows XP installer you can begin to go through the VirtualBox installer if it is done.

There's a couple of files involved in this process, but first we'll install VirtualBox, then a Windows XP virtual machine, then install Bryce 3 on that virtual machine. Then we'll extract Bryce 3 from the virtual machine's storage and put it on our main storage.

Taking Bryce out of the virtual machine is much better than keeping it in for a multitude of reasons, but the main two are convenience and bug avoiding.

Setting up VirtualBox

By now all three of the files we downloaded should be done. First we'll need the **VirtualBox installer**, so **run it and go through the installation process**. You won't need certain extras like the python stuff but since the virtual machine is temporary just leave everything ticked. Run VirtualBox once the installer is done.

You should be greeted with a window like this unless you've installed VirtualBox before. From here, click the **New** button at the top. Give your virtual machine a name, then select the ISO Image box and find your Windows XP ISO. You'll also need to fill in info in the *Set Up Unattended guest OS Installation* section. Put in an easy password and enter the serial key found on the XP Internet Archive page.

Very importantly, go to *Specific Virtual Hard Disk* and **set the Hard Disk File Type to VHD**. This is because Windows can mount VHDs but can't mount VirtualBox's default VDIs.

Setting up XP

Create the virtual machine and start it up. You'll need to wait for XP to install (in case you didn't notice, this process requires a lot of waiting. Probably more waiting than activity).

While you wait, head back to VirtualBox and **go to the Media section on the left sidebar**. Go to the Optical Disks section, then Add, then find the Bryce3DCD.iso and select it.

Installing Bryce

Once XP finally greets you with bliss, go to the top of the virtual machine and go to Devices > Optical Disks and tick the Bryce3DCD.iso file. Then in XP go to My Computer, find and open the Bryce3DCD.iso disk, then run SETUP. On XP the SETUP file should be an old desktop PC.

Go through the Bryce 3D installer and remember where it installs. By default it installs in C:\Bryce 3D. At this point you can open Bryce and use it, but we'll be taking it out of Windows XP for ease of access and to let it run properly. If you try to use it on XP all of the controls are super sensitive and precise controlling becomes impossible. Not exactly ideal for creating renders, so we're breaking it out.

Getting Bryce off XP

Power off the virtual machine and in VirtualBox head to the Media section again and look under **Hard Disks** for an item sharing the name of your virtual machine. Right click it and first Release it. Then right click it again, go to its properties and check where it is located, then **find it in File Explorer**.

Bryce 3 is in this .vhd file but first we need to mount it to our own system. Using Windows' search bar open **Disk Management** (it may be called *Create and format hard disk partitions*). Then go to Action > Attach VHD, then browse and find the .vhd file from the virtual machine. Once it is attached, go into the disk through File Explorer, find the Bryce 3D folder and copy it to somewhere on your main system like your Desktop.

Bryce 3 is now on your system! You can open it now and enter your serial key (specifically the one with the numbers only). Also you may need to mount the Bryce3DCD.iso file to your main computer while you register.

All Done!

If you want to **clean up VirtualBox**, go back to the menu with your virtual machine listed, right click it and select Remove. Then check *Delete Virtual Machine Files*. To uninstall VirtualBox you'll need to use Windows' Add or Remove Programs section in settings. At this point you can delete the VirtualBox and XP installers but I'd recommend keeping the Bryce3DCD image in case you want the prefabs that were bundled with it.

